

has more to do with diet, exercise, and state of mind than with fancy hospital equipment. I've explained how I gave myself a severe stomachache shortly after I retired. Some say that as much as 30 percent or more of illness is psychosomatic and that 70 percent or more has a psychosomatic component. Have the right attitude about your body and chances are you'll stay healthy and have better health care. It matters very little whether you're in Brazil or Boston.

Shortly after our move to Argentina, Vicki tripped and broke her foot in a small beach town three hundred miles from Buenos Aires. The local clinic set the bone but it proved unstable. The clinic doctor recommended surgery to put a pin through the bone and hold it in place. It sounded complicated. Should we fly back to Buenos Aires?

The clinic doctor found an "excellent" orthopedic surgeon vacationing nearby and brought him in. Vicki "interviewed" him—he didn't speak English and we were still trying to learn Spanish—and decided to go with him. He had studied in France and had been chosen by the Argentine army to operate on soldiers wounded in the 1982 South Atlantic war with England.

The operation started at 10:00 P.M. so that the surgeon could have a full day at the beach. The operating room had cobwebs on the ceiling. Novocaine was the only anesthesia available. The X-ray equipment looked like something from *M.A.S.H.* No nurses were around, so two clinic doctors assisted. Vicki said afterward the surgical team reminded her of the Three Stooges.

All went fine. We found out later, in Buenos Aires, that the surgeon had used a fairly advanced puncture technique. Was Vicki "just lucky"? We think not. Our experience is that Americans can find high-quality medical care abroad if they use good judgment, have the right attitude, and exercise a little caution.

The surgery, operating room, medicines, and follow-up care for Vicki's operation cost \$400. Medical care in the